

Benjamin Smith

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SUMMARY

Marketing, production, and product-operations hybrid with deep experience helping independent game studios move from development through launch and live operations. Published and marketed 75+ indie games in under 18 months at indie.io, serving as full marketing and project lead for roughly half the catalog. Strong background in developer relations, release coordination, storefront strategy, platform workflows, and AI-assisted internal tooling. Built and shipped a suite of operational tools covering creator outreach automation, festival submission workflows, Steamworks tools, press kit infrastructure, and developer communications systems, reducing manual workload across recurring marketing operations.

SKILLS

GAMING & PUBLISHING

Steam / Steamworks · PlayStation · Xbox · Nintendo · GOG · Epic · storefront optimization · capsule art · store page localization · festival submissions · catalog management · certification workflows

MARKETING & CAMPAIGN

Launch marketing · press kit development · PR coordination · creator outreach · wishlist strategy · KPI analysis · campaign analytics · event coverage · post-launch operations

PROJECT & RELEASE MANAGEMENT

Wrike · release coordination · developer relations · cross-functional team coordination · roadmap prioritization · task tracking · asset pipeline management

AI & TECHNICAL

Claude · Claude Code · Python · TypeScript / Next.js · Playwright browser automation · Slack and Wrike API integrations · Steamworks automation · AI-assisted workflow design

EXPERIENCE

Marketing Manager / Project and Product Manager

February 2025 – May 2026

indie.io · Remote

- Published, marketed, and project-managed 75+ indie games in under 18 months across PC, console, and mobile within a 200+ title active publishing portfolio, contributing to 3M+ Steam wishlist additions and 1.3M+ units sold portfolio-wide during tenure.
- Served as full marketing and project lead for roughly half the catalog, owning developer relationships, release schedules, campaign execution, asset pipelines, and cross-functional coordination across Marketing, Creative, PR, DevOps, QA, Business Development, storefronts, influencer, events, and community teams.
- Built and executed title-specific marketing strategies informed by audience insights, wishlist trends, sales performance, and campaign analytics, covering end-to-end release workflows: store setup, localization, capsule art, festival submissions, key partner setup, press materials, launch communications, and post-release beats.
- Built a Steamworks automation toolkit covering tag research and optimization, store page localization, capsule asset production, CD key management, and batch key revocation, along with a companion browser extension for reliable automated Steamworks session handling.
- Automated the highest-friction recurring workflows: a developer communications system that generated context-aware Slack message drafts for each manager's review and send, and wrote completions back to Wrike; an AI-screened festival submission pipeline that produced Wrike task blueprints for approved events; and a daily briefing aggregating release deadlines, open tasks, and communication flags across the full catalog.
- Built a creator outreach platform (Steam-linked campaign management, key distribution, ROI tracking), a self-service press kit platform (Steam import, media storage, public press pages), and an internal tool portal standardizing deployment, health monitoring, and documentation across all marketing tools.

Producer / Production Manager

February 2021 – February 2025

Lillymo Games · Remote

- Managed platform submission workflows for PlayStation, Xbox, Nintendo, and Steam, including metadata, assets, pricing, promotions, certification readiness, and catalog updates.
- Reduced submission and approval friction by improving coordination between developers, platform holders, and internal stakeholders.
- Collaborated with platform representatives to resolve publishing issues, negotiate promotions, and improve visibility for releases.
- Implemented internal processes for build readiness, certification scheduling, task communication, and release tracking, improving operational consistency for a small studio.

Partner

February 2019 – Present

Lambsmith PR · Remote

- Partner with independent game studios and media creators on PR, launch planning, campaign positioning, and audience development.
- Develop press materials, pitches, messaging, and outreach plans tailored to each game's genre, audience, release timing, and platform strategy.
- Coordinate review opportunities, creator and media outreach, event coverage, and launch communications across indie game campaigns.
- Advise clients on store page presentation, key beats, announcement timing, and practical marketing workflows for small teams.

Producer

December 2020 – January 2025

Last Stand Media · Remote

- Led scalable production workflows for a high-volume podcast and video content operation, improving consistency, turnaround time, and quality control.
- Coordinated live events including logistics, technical requirements, scheduling, and talent coordination.

Editor-In-Chief

December 2016 – September 2022

Handsome Phantom · Remote

- Led editorial operations for a team of writers and creators producing game reviews, previews, podcasts, interviews, and features.
- Cultivated relationships with developers and PR representatives to secure review opportunities, early access, event access, and coverage.

Partner / Owner

August 2013 – September 2022

Reclamation Brewing Company · Butler, PA

- Co-founded and operated a brewery with a team of ~20, building and managing systems for payroll, scheduling, accounting, staff management, vendor relations, and day-to-day business administration.
- Established partnerships and local marketing efforts that supported revenue growth, brand consistency, and community visibility.

Mayor

January 2018 – January 2022

City of Butler, Pennsylvania · Butler, PA

- Led all city operations for a municipality of ~15,000 residents, overseeing a \$12M+ annual budget across public safety, infrastructure, code enforcement, community development, and cross-departmental services.
- Built structured communication and reporting practices to improve transparency, coordination, and organizational follow-through across city departments.

Senior Admissions Counselor / Senior Financial Aid Counselor

August 2010 – September 2016

Geneva College · Beaver Falls, PA

- Managed recruitment and financial aid workflows for prospective and current students.
- Developed strategies to support student enrollment, retention, and cross-departmental coordination.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, Higher Education

Geneva College · Beaver Falls, PA · 2014

Bachelor of Science, Business Administration

Minor in Management, Marketing, Finance · The Pennsylvania State University · State College, PA · 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

- Product Management Basics, Pendo
- Claude 101, Anthropic
- Claude Code 101, Anthropic
- Claude Code in Action, Anthropic